

SEO, Performance & Quality Checklist

Checklist covering technical SEO, content optimization, schema markup, framework-specific practices (Next.js/React), link building, internationalization, and ongoing maintenance. This version has been deduplicated against the companion checklists (a11y, Security, Frontend Performance, Backend & API) so there is no overlap.

Scope: Items that appeared in the original version but are now covered by the *Web Accessibility Checklist* (semantic HTML, heading hierarchy, alt text, form labels, keyboard/screen reader testing, video captions, mobile testing), *Web Security Checklist*, *Frontend Performance Checklist* (Core Web Vitals, compression, caching, lazy loading, critical CSS, performance budgets, Lighthouse, viewport meta), or *Backend & API Checklist* have been removed. What remains is unique to SEO, content strategy, structured data, and framework optimization.

HIGH PRIORITY

Address first. These directly impact search visibility and discoverability: page-level SEO meta tags, technical crawling, and search engine fundamentals.

☐	Checklist Item	Source
Meta Elements & Page-Level SEO		
☐	Write unique, descriptive title tags for every page (50–60 characters); front-load the most specific keyword	Mind map
☐	Write compelling meta descriptions for every page (120–160 characters) that accurately summarize content	Mind map
☐	Implement robots meta tags (index/noindex, follow/nofollow) appropriately per page	Mind map
☐	Add Open Graph tags (og:title, og:description, og:image, og:type) for social sharing previews	Mind map
☐	Add Twitter Card tags (twitter:card, twitter:title, twitter:description, twitter:image) for rich social previews	Mind map
Crawling Efficiency & Technical SEO		
☐	Create and submit an XML sitemap listing all canonical, indexable pages; keep it updated	Mind map
☐	Configure robots.txt to allow search engine access to important resources and block admin/staging paths	Mind map
☐	Implement canonical tags on every page to prevent duplicate content issues	Mind map
☐	Use proper HTTP status codes for redirects: 301 for permanent, 302/307 for temporary; avoid redirect chains	Mind map

☐	Checklist Item	Source
☐	Design clean, descriptive URL slugs: lowercase, hyphen-separated, keyword-relevant, no unnecessary parameters	Mind map
☐	Handle pagination with rel="next"/rel="prev" or load-more patterns; avoid infinite scroll without crawlable links	Mind map
☐	Identify and fix orphan pages (pages not linked from anywhere else on the site)	Mind map
☐	Ensure the site is fully crawlable with JavaScript rendering off, or use SSR/SSG for critical content	Best practices
Search Engine Fundamentals		
☐	Understand how your site is crawled and indexed; monitor crawl stats in Google Search Console	Mind map
☐	Align content with user search intent: informational, navigational, transactional, or commercial investigation	Mind map
☐	Understand search result page anatomy (featured snippets, People Also Ask, knowledge panels) and optimize for them	Mind map
☐	Identify and fix search engine safety issues: manual actions, malware warnings, or hacked content notices	Mind map
Quotation & Citation Markup		
☐	Use blockquote and cite elements for quotations with proper attribution	Mind map



MEDIUM PRIORITY

Tackle once high-priority items are solid. Covers structured data, content/keyword strategy, Next.js and React optimization, internal linking, and link building.

☐	Checklist Item	Source
Schema Markup & Structured Data		
☐	Implement JSON-LD structured data (preferred over Microdata or RDFa) on relevant pages	Mind map
☐	Add Organization schema on the homepage with name, logo, contactPoint, and sameAs links	Mind map
☐	Add Article/BlogPosting schema on content pages with headline, author, datePublished, dateModified	Mind map
☐	Add Person schema for author pages and team profiles with name, jobTitle, image, sameAs	Mind map
☐	Add BreadcrumbList schema to match the visible breadcrumb navigation	Mind map
☐	Add Event schema for event pages with name, startDate, location, offers	Mind map
☐	Add Product schema for product pages with name, image, description, offers, reviews/aggregateRating	Mind map
☐	Validate all structured data using Google's Rich Results Test and Schema.org validator	Best practices
Content Optimization & Keyword Strategy		
☐	Conduct keyword research using search volume, keyword difficulty, and user intent analysis	Mind map
☐	Target long-tail keywords for less competitive, higher-intent search traffic	Mind map
☐	Perform competitive gap analysis: find keywords competitors rank for that you don't	Mind map
☐	Organize content around keyword clusters (topic groups) rather than isolated keywords	Mind map
☐	Monitor seasonal trends and adjust content calendar accordingly	Mind map
☐	Distribute header tags (h2–h4) strategically with relevant keywords and clear topic structure	Mind map
☐	Place primary keywords in title tag, h1, first paragraph, and URL slug naturally	Mind map
☐	Write descriptive, keyword-relevant alt text for images (SEO perspective, complementing a11y requirements)	Mind map

☐	Checklist Item	Source
☐	Balance content length for the topic: comprehensive enough to satisfy intent without padding	Mind map
☐	Improve readability scores: short sentences, simple vocabulary, scannable structure	Mind map
☐	Include relevant external outbound links to authoritative sources	Mind map
Next.js Optimization		
☐	Use next/image component for automatic image optimization, responsive sizing, and lazy loading	Mind map
☐	Implement script loading strategies: use next/script with strategy="lazyOnload" or "afterInteractive" for third-party scripts	Mind map
☐	Optimize fonts with next/font for zero layout shift and automatic self-hosting	Mind map
☐	Configure link prefetching behavior: disable for low-priority links, keep for primary navigation	Mind map
☐	Generate dynamic metadata using generateMetadata() for server-rendered pages	Mind map
☐	Choose the right rendering strategy per route: SSR for dynamic, SSG/ISR for content-heavy, streaming for long loads	Mind map
☐	Use static site generation (SSG) for marketing pages, blog posts, and documentation	Mind map
React Best Practices		
☐	Use fragments to avoid unnecessary wrapper DOM elements that bloat the tree	Mind map
☐	Avoid prop drilling: use context, composition patterns, or state management where appropriate	Mind map
☐	Abstract reusable logic into custom hooks to keep components focused and testable	Mind map
☐	Implement error boundaries at route and feature boundaries to prevent full-app crashes	Mind map
Internal Linking Architecture		
☐	Use varied, descriptive anchor text for internal links (avoid "click here" or bare URLs)	Mind map
☐	Place contextual internal links within body content pointing to related pages	Mind map
☐	Structure navigation menus with clear hierarchy: primary nav, secondary/utility nav, footer nav	Mind map

☐	Checklist Item	Source
☐	Organize footer links by category with links to key conversion and informational pages	Mind map
☐	Link category/hub pages to their child pages and vice versa; maintain topic clusters	Mind map
☐	Add related content modules ("You may also like", "Related articles") on content pages	Mind map
☐	Audit for and fix orphan pages that have no internal links pointing to them	Mind map
Link Building & External Outreach		
☐	Assess backlink quality: prioritize links from relevant, authoritative domains over quantity	Mind map
☐	Pursue guest content contributions on reputable industry publications	Mind map
☐	Find and reclaim broken external links pointing to your domain (broken link building)	Mind map
☐	Build relationships through digital PR: data-driven content, original research, expert commentary	Mind map
☐	Monitor brand mentions and request link attribution for unlinked mentions	Mind map
☐	Get listed on relevant resource pages and industry directories	Mind map
☐	Amplify content through social media to increase discovery and natural linking	Mind map



LOW PRIORITY

Valuable for mature programs. Covers SEO-specific auditing, content QA, international SEO, and ongoing maintenance strategies.

☐	Checklist Item	Source
Automated SEO Auditing		
☐	Set up automated crawl simulation (Screaming Frog, Sitebulb, or similar) to detect technical SEO issues	Mind map
☐	Run automated broken link detection on a schedule; fix or redirect broken internal/external links	Mind map
Manual Content & QA Review		
☐	Review content clarity: is it scannable, well-organized, and free of jargon for the target audience?	Mind map
☐	Inspect the document structure (heading outline, landmark regions) using browser extensions	Mind map
☐	Collect and act on user feedback about usability, content gaps, and friction points	Mind map
International SEO & Localization		
☐	Implement hreflang tags correctly for all language/region variants of each page	Mind map
☐	Choose and implement a URL structure for localization: subdirectories (/en/, /fr/) vs. subdomains vs. ccTLDs	Mind map
☐	Select the right domain strategy based on target markets and budget (ccTLD, gTLD, subdomain)	Mind map
☐	Adapt content culturally, not just linguistically: date formats, currency, imagery, idioms, examples	Mind map
☐	Optimize for local search: Google Business Profile, localized content, region-specific keywords	Mind map
☐	Support currency localization and time zone handling in application logic and display	Mind map
Maintenance Strategies & Periodic Reviews		
☐	Review analytics data regularly: identify top-performing pages, declining pages, and drop-off points	Mind map
☐	Monitor Google Search Console for crawl errors, indexing issues, and manual actions; resolve promptly	Mind map
☐	Conduct content pruning sessions: consolidate thin content, remove outdated pages, redirect retired URLs	Mind map

☐	Checklist Item	Source
☐	Track and reduce technical debt: outdated dependencies, deprecated patterns, TODO comments, skipped tests	Mind map
☐	Monitor competitor strategy evolution: new content, features, keyword targeting, and backlink patterns	Mind map
☐	Stay current with industry guideline updates: Google algorithm changes, WCAG versions, framework releases, Web Platform Baseline	Mind map

Generated March 2026. Deduplicated against: Web Accessibility Checklist, Web Security Checklist, Frontend Performance Checklist, and Backend Performance & API Security Checklist.